



Printers

Printers morphed from plainjane printing devices to MFDs or multifunctional devices that do much more than just print. The next step in the evolution of MFDs was witnessed this year by way of

technological advancements and feature upgrades such as cloud printing etc that were implemented by some brands. Other than that manufacturers printing solutions tried to bring down the overall costs per print.

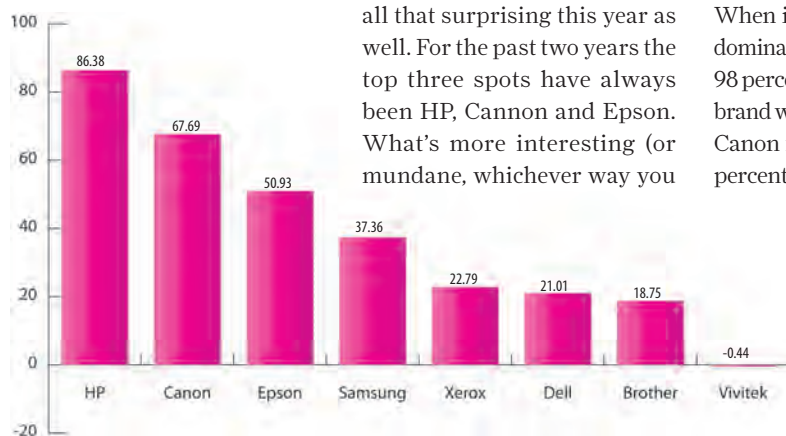
Our survey results were not all that surprising this year as well. For the past two years the top three spots have always been HP, Canon and Epson. What's more interesting (or mundane, whichever way you

look at it) is that even the order hasn't changed. HP came out on top of the trust index with a score of 86.38 followed by Canon at 67.69. The gap certainly has widened between the two leaders from last year. Reclaiming its third spot this year again was Epson with a score of 53.97 percent.

Key findings:

When it came to awareness HP dominated top of mind recall with 98 percent people thinking of the brand when asked about printers. Canon followed closely with 93 percent recall. Epson was fairly remembered with just under 90 percent.

In ownership as well HP was at the top with 70 percent of our respondents possessing HP printers.



HP
Though HP may not be doing so well in other categories like Laptops, in Printers it is undisputedly the most trusted brand.



A new entrant debuted in our trust index this year. The surprise entry by Dell was at the number five spot. Brother on the other hand got pushed down one spot to the sixth place.



Internal Hard Drives

Right from the start of the year manufacturers tried to capture the market by upping capacity. All three major manufacturers viz. Western Digital, Hitachi and Seagate now have their 3TB versions. Each of the brands came up with their own workarounds for achieving such capacities. With the WD drives, you needed a host bus adapter to use the full 3TB capacity. Also a term that was heard quite often

was advanced 4K format, which basically combines eight 512-byte sectors to overcome the 2.19TB barrier that was present in previous generation hard drives. Seagate achieved 3TB drive using the 512-byte sector to make it compatible with older systems running windows XP. As far as the internal storage (mechanical hard drives only) industry goes, there are only two titans remaining now – Western Digital and Seagate, thanks to Western Digital's acquisition of Hitachi storage division. But Hitachi drives are still sold under the Hitachi brand name. Speaking of acquisitions, the storage industry seems to be consolidating itself

even further. Seagate recently acquired Samsung's Hard Disk Drive division which was primarily into laptop HDDs.

Coming to the results of our Icons of Trust survey in this category, it pretty much mirrored the findings from the External Drives category. Seagate was the clear winner with a score of 80.48 followed by Western Digital with 67.44. Since the space does not have too many players there were only three other brands featured in the trust index viz. Samsung, which came third with 32.76, followed by Hitachi with 24.67 and finally Toshiba with 19.48.

Key Findings

1. As expected Seagate and WD own the lion's share of the drives owned by our respondents. Close to 50 percent of the drives were Seagate while about 30 percent

SEAGATE

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were WD. On the contrary, totally about 5 percent of the drives were reportedly from brands such as Silicon Power, Imation etc. Most likely SSDs.

2. Based on their experience, owners of WD drives seemed slightly happier with their purchases. 81.20 percent of those surveyed said they would purchase products of a different category from the brand. While in the case of Seagate it was 79.50 percent.

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